

Every Request Treated Equally. None of Them Should Be.

A rule-based VA chat platform for Dell India's Out-of-Warranty support; routing by complexity X revenue, not queue position.

Table of Contents

Dell India OOW VA Chatbot — product proposal and implementation plan

01 The Problem

Why the current OOW support operation is structurally broken

02 Who it affects ?

Five personas caught in the same broken queue

03 Product Discovery

The research and data that shaped what we built

04 The Solution

VA chatbot v1 — rule-based decision engine on Salesforce

05 Business Case

What this costs Dell and how it pays back

06 Key Capabilities

Six capabilities the platform delivers

07 User Journey

How a customer moves from first contact to resolution

08 Business Value

Why better support pays twice — for Dell and for the customer

09 Metrics & KPIs

How we know it's working — North Star, KPIs, supporting metrics

10 Implementation plan

Roadmap, team structure, and sprint planning — Q1 to Q4

THE PROBLEM: Every request gets equal treatment, regardless of revenue or complexity

Scope: laptops, desktops, monitors ~ hardware, software, tracking, quality, informational queries

70%+ of customer service interactions will begin through a conversational AI interface by 2028. But Dell's OOW (out of warranty) support is still 100% human-gated at first contact, across all three existing channels. ([Gartner, Customer Service AI Use Cases](#))



B2C

Individual Consumer

No priority signal

40–60% of consumer volume needs zero human judgment but all of it still gets a live agent today.



B2B

Enterprise IT

1–3 day quote cycle

4–6 manual handoffs, no audit trail on WhatsApp, enterprise clients default to the slowest channel, email even with AM. Non-AM accounts: no structured channel, hence forced onto voice.



Internal

OOW agents & operations

Agent capacity, untracked

Zero-judgment work fills the day, bulk leads and real escalations wait, with no measurement of what's lost.



Leadership takeaway: Implementing a triage layer isn't about improving 'customer experience' metrics, it's a operational necessity to stop agents from burning hours on low-value tasks while major revenue opportunities wait with zero priority signals.

Five people caught in the same broken queue

Spanning B2C, B2B (AM-covered and non-AM), and Internal Dell stakeholders

Priya Sharma

B2C

Individual consumer

Wants: To check her warranty or get a repair booked without sitting on hold.

Frustration: She still ends up with a full agent, even for something as simple as a status check.

"She's already on WhatsApp, but it's just another ticket queue, not real self-service."

Rajesh Iyer

B2B

IT Manager, AM-covered, Enterprise-scale

Wants: A bulk fleet quote fast enough that he can raise a PO without procurement pushing back.

Frustration: There's no structured way to submit a request, so he's describing every device over email and waiting through 4 to 6 handoffs before a quote shows up.

"Everything routes through his AM, since WhatsApp won't give him an audit trail."

Anjali Mehta

B2B

Mid-market, Non-AM lead, 40-man firm

Wants: Her devices fixed, without the overhead a much bigger account would need.

Frustration: No dedicated AM, no structured channel, so she's stuck on voice calls, the slowest option there is.

"She re-explains the whole issue from scratch every single time she calls."

Arjun Verma

Internal

OOW support agent

Wants: To spend the shift on quotes and edge cases that actually need a human.

Frustration: Every ticket looks the same until he opens it, a quick redirect and a bulk repair lead sit in the exact same queue.

"He's manually checking every ticket just to figure out what kind of case it even is."

Meera Nair

Internal

Account manager

Wants: Her accounts healthy; fast quotes, clean PO tracking, nothing blowing up on her clients.

Frustration: She's manually coordinating between the IT team, the inbox, and whichever agent picks up the case with no real visibility into where things stand.

"Most days she's chasing updates instead of actually managing the relationship."

Product Discovery: What we learned before we built

Every feature in VA chatbot v1 is traceable to a specific finding — this slide shows the research that made that possible



Menu strategy: Main menu built around 5 highest-volume inbound categories • Hardware sub-menu built around 5 highest call drivers from voice, WhatsApp, CRM logs, and part replacement order history



How we collected data

- Voice, WhatsApp, email channel analysis
- CRM case logs + part replacement orders
- Agent + AM interviews
- B2C + B2B customer intercepts
- Competitive benchmarking — HP, Lenovo

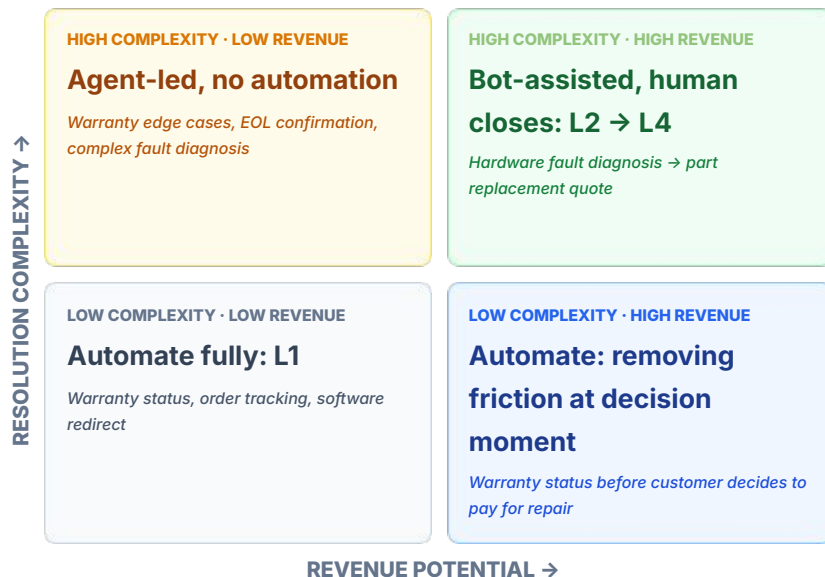


What we tracked

- Query type distribution by channel
- AHT per query type vs. resolution value
- Part replacement conversion rate
- Channel preference — B2C vs. B2B
- Drop-off points before resolution

Complexity × Revenue engine

Core v1 architectural decision: every automation mapped here



Discovery output: v1 scope locked

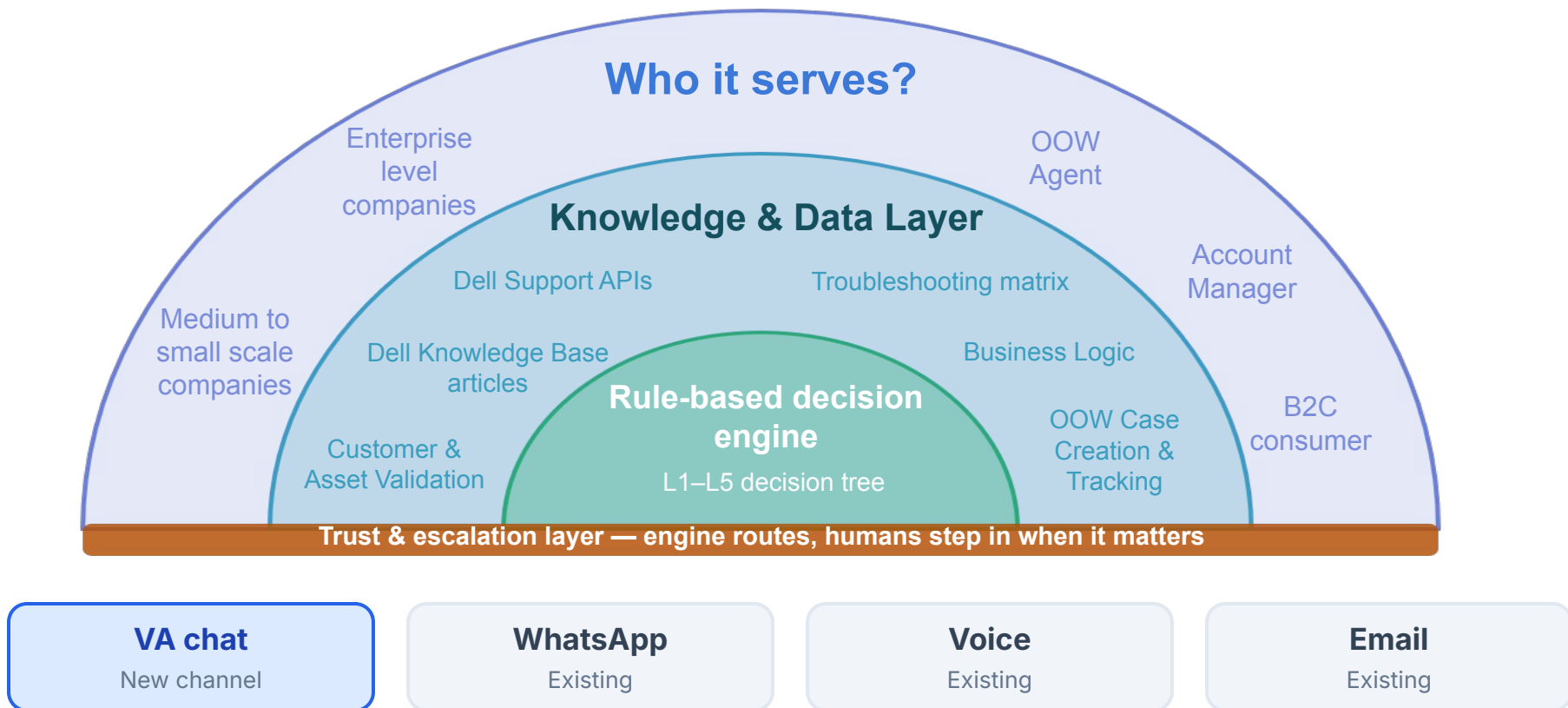
- **L1 fully automated:** warranty status, order tracking, software redirect
- **L2 bot-led diagnosis:** human closes when tree exhausted or part replacement identified
- **L3/L4/L5 on single voluntary connect path:** agent SOP determines case type post-handoff
- **WhatsApp automation deferred to Q3:** same decision trees, different platform (Sprinklr)
- **B2B structured intake form deferred:** clients share device details directly in chat with agent



Product discovery drove every version1 (v1) decision, hence nothing was built on assumption. The Complexity × Revenue engine is the single lens that determined what to automate, what to assist, and what to leave human.

Product Proposal: Dell OOW VA Support Engine

A rule-based decision engine at the core — every request routed by complexity and revenue potential, not queue position



Business Case: What this costs and how it pays back

VA chatbot v1 is an operational investment — not a new revenue stream. It protects and grows revenue Dell already has.



What this costs Dell ?

ONE-TIME BUILD

- Salesforce bot configuration and decision tree build
- Decision tree documentation and QA → full L1-L5 path coverage
- API integration → service tag, warranty, Dell Support APIs

ONGOING OPERATIONAL

- Salesforce platform and bot licensing → scales with usage tier, not query volume
- Decision tree maintenance as products and policies change
- Ongoing team → Salesforce dev, SMEs, Analysts, QA, etc; proportional to platform scale, not a fixed overhead
- No separate compute cost → rule-based engine runs natively on Salesforce

What it offsets:

~₹650/hour — L2 frontline agent fully loaded

~₹1,300/hour — L3 senior technical agent

Source: [Wisemonk India CX Report 2026](#)



How it pays back ?

Dell's only two OOW revenue sources are **parts replacement** and **warranty extensions**. VA chatbot v1 protects and grows both.

1

More repair leads converted

Hardware fault queries diagnosed in L2 reach agents faster → a customer ready to pay no longer queues behind a status check

2

Higher retention driving repeat purchases

Dell's brand loyalty fell from 65.5% to mid-40s in one year in India → support quality is one of the few levers Dell directly controls at the repurchase moment ([91mobiles 2026](#))

3

Lower cost per resolution

50–60% of inbound volume is L1-resolvable at under ₹15 per query → versus ₹650+/hour for a live agent (*Industry standard for enterprise hardware support operations i.e., consistent with ITIL v4 tiered support framework and HDI benchmarking data*)

★ Every rupee saved on zero-judgment L1 queries is a rupee available for the hardware repair leads that actually generate revenue.

Key Capabilities of the VA Chat Support Platform

Six capabilities, one core engine — every list item is what the engine makes possible



Rule-based L1-L5 triage engine Core capability

Classifies every incoming request by revenue potential and complexity before it reaches a human and routes it accordingly. Every other capability on this slide depends on this engine working correctly.

Pain point: Identical treatment for every request regardless of value.

OOW Agent



Instant self-service resolution

Service tag, warranty, software redirects resolved autonomously, no agent involved.

B2C consumer



Structured B2B bulk intake

Streamlines fleet requests via chat to eliminate 4–6 email handoffs. Every interaction auto-logs in Salesforce, for a full enterprise audit trail.

B2B enterprise (AM-covered)



Structured channel for non-AM accounts

Chat intake gives mid-market accounts a proper channel instead of defaulting to voice. Every interaction auto-logs in Salesforce, to give non-AM clients a full audit trail.

B2B mid-market (Non AM Covered)



Pre-triaged handoff & intake visibility

AMs get live visibility into request statuses without chasing updates. Agents receive context-complete, revenue-sorted cases instead of a blind queue.

OOW agent + Account Manager



Context-complete escalation

Agent receives live conversation + full case history via service tag, hence no cold transfer, no re-explaining.

B2C + B2B + OOW agent

User Journey: From first contact to resolution

Every customer follows the same entry path — where they go next depends on why they reached out

1 Entry & Validation

- Customer opens VA chat, enters service tag → 3-attempt validation
- Bot silently checks warranty status and active cases
- OOH check runs → agent connect suppressed outside 9AM – 6PM IST

2 Main Menu (Five Paths)

Check warranty status

L1

Software, OS & drivers

L1

Order & dispatch status

L1

Hardware & performance

L2

Connect to live agent

L3/L4/L5

3 Resolution or Handoff

- L1:** Resolves instantly → closing loop
- L2:** KB resolves → closing loop, or part replacement / tree exhausted → agent handoff
- L3/L4/L5:** Agent handles per SOP → session closes → survey triggered

Agent connect → 3 touchpoints

- Main menu → Option 5
- After knowledge base (KB) answer in hardware flow
- After software redirect

Out-of-hours handling

- Out of Hours (OOH) check runs at every handoff point
- Agent connect suppressed outside 9AM – 6PM IST
- Customer redirected to Dell.com with working hours

Closing loop

- "Anything else?" asked after every L1 resolution
- Yes → returns to main menu with OOH recheck
- No → session ends, survey auto-triggers

[View the full user journey →](#)

<https://userjourneyflowchart.web.app/>

Better Support Pays Twice: For the customer and for Dell

Every gain on the business side has a mirror on the customer side — the loop below is the actual investment case.

Business value — Dell

Lower cost to serve

AI absorbs high-volume, zero-judgment queries, hence agents freed for revenue work

Faster revenue conversion

Repair leads reach agents first and not after sitting behind a status check

Stronger retention

Directly tackles Dell's steepest loyalty drop in India i.e., 65.5% to mid-40s in one year

End-user value — Customer

Instant answers

Status checks, warranty lookups, basic troubleshooting; all resolved without a queue

Same-session B2B quotes

Structured intake replaces the 4-6 handoff email chain, hence customer receives quote in one session

Right-sized support

Handled by complexity and need and not by queue position

The investment loop



Fast support



More loyalty



Repeat buys



Better margin



reinvested into the platform

 reinvested — not pocketed

Product metrics & KPIs: How we know it's working

Four outcome KPIs tied directly to the North Star — supported by five diagnostic metrics that explain why each KPI moves



NORTH STAR METRIC - Incremental OOW revenue attributable to VA chat

Measured by comparing conversion rate and time-to-quote for VA-routed cases against legacy-channel cases

KPI TREE

Incremental OOW revenue via VA chat



First call resolution rate

% cases closed in one session, no reopen



Channel adoption rate

% of volume on VA chat vs. voice, email, WhatsApp



Repeat contact rate

Same device recontact within 30 days via service tag



Intake & flow completion rate

B2B: Structured intake form completed end-to-end.
B2C: Session completed without mid-flow abandonment.

SUPPORTING METRICS



Premature escalation rate

% requesting agent before bot attempts resolution



Agent productivity rate

Resolved cases per agent per active hour



Branch failure rate

Decision tree branches triggering unexpected escalations



CSAT score

Post-interaction satisfaction rating



NPS

Loyalty and retention signal

RECOMMENDED FOCUS AREAS

- 1 Drive VA adoption**
Channel adoption rate is the earliest signal; if customers aren't using it, nothing else matters
- 2 Optimise decision trees**
Branch failure and premature escalation rates show exactly where the engine needs fixing
- 3 Reduce abandonment**
Intake & flow completion rate flags where B2B and B2C users are dropping off before resolution

★ All four KPIs populate automatically from existing case-routing data, hence no manual tracking is required.

Implementation Plan

Full project detail — roadmap, sprints, and team structure — lives on our Confluence and Jira workspace



Quarterly Roadmap

- Q1 Build:** VA chatbot v1 live for B2C
- Q2 Learn:** agent training + B2B onboarding
- Q3 Optimize:** decision trees + WhatsApp bot
- Q4 Scale:** BPO training + future-proofing



Team Structure

- Product + Project Management 2
- Salesforce Developers 2
- Solution Architect + BA + QA 3
- Data Analyst + Training Lead 2
- Dell OOW SMEs 2
- Core dedicated team 11**
- Internal OOW agents (existing, Q1+): TBC
- BPO agents (external partner, Q4): TBC



Sprint Planning

- Two-week sprints across all quarters
- Q1 fully planned; 6 sprints across 5 epics, 27 stories, 157 story points
- Q2 – Q4 planned at start of each quarter based on previous quarter's retrospective data
- Sprint reviews require a working demo, not a status update

View the full implementation plan

Full project detail → quarterly roadmap, team structure, sprint board with 27 stories across 6 sprints, and documentation

[Launch](#) →

Thank You!



LinkedIn

linkedin.com/in/sunidhi-mishra



GitHub

github.com/sunidhi-mishra



Portfolio

sunidhimishra.com





ABBREVIATIONS

- OOW - Out of Warranty
- AM - Account Manager
- VA - Virtual Assistant



[Go Back](#)



[Main Menu](#)